

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 573

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Crossett Franklin, Sr., of Memphis.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Crossett Franklin, Sr., of Memphis; and

WHEREAS, Crossett Franklin, Sr., was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, born in Memphis on December 28, 1950, Crossett Franklin was the son of Roosevelt and Rosa Lee Franklin and a 1969 graduate of Hamilton High School; one of his greatest joys was agriculture, and from a young age, he cherished working the land and celebrating special moments in his community; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Franklin earned a bachelor's degree in political science and a master's degree in public administration from Memphis State University, presently known as the University of Memphis; and

WHEREAS, Crossett Franklin served the State of Tennessee with acumen and alacrity as a business accounts and tax auditor, taking his much-deserved retirement following thirty-five years of devoted service; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his work with the State, Mr. Franklin was a realtor and an investor for more than four decades, retiring from Lawrence Johnson Realtors, Inc., in 2018; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Franklin was also deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly missed but fondly remembered by his children, Carsett Franklin Webber, Lashunda Franklin (Eddie) Gatewood, and Crossett Franklin, Jr.; his grandchildren, Sierra Franklin, Jada Franklin, Keelon Webber, Kaitlyn Webber, Madyson Gatewood, Ethan Gatewood, Crossett Franklin III, Lailah Franklin, and Sebastian Franklin; his siblings, Rosa Knox, Patricia Franklin (Maurice) Norman, Maxine Campbell, Dr. Joyce (Horace) Freshwater, and Brenda (Lloyd) Patterson; his sisters-in-law, Diane Stewart and Theresa Fair; his aunt, Fannie Stark; his uncle, Walter Hill; and a host of cousins, nieces, and nephews; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, Mr. Franklin was preceded in death by his beloved wife, Delores "Too Sweet" Fair; his son, Darryl Franklin; his grandson, Eddie Alexander Gatewood; and his brothers, Joe Thomas and Larry Franklin; and

WHEREAS, Crossett Franklin accepted Christ at an early age and attended Breath of Life Christian Center; and

WHEREAS, the epitome of love and faith, Mr. Franklin was a wise soul who impacted the lives of those who were blessed to know him, and he leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to pay tribute to his bountiful life of purpose and service; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Crossett Franklin, Sr., reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family and friends of Mr. Franklin.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.